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The Friends Who Fade

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Introduction: The Empty Chair at the Table

I have an empty chair at the table. The chair is the chair of the friend who has faded. The chair is the chair of the friend who has moved. The chair is the chair of the friend who has died. The chair is the chair of the friend who has drifted.

The empty chair is the centerpiece of the 50+ life. The empty chair is the chair that reminds you of the friends who are no longer there. The empty chair is the chair that reminds you of the friends who are no longer in your life. The empty chair is the chair that is the work of the year.

The empty chair is not the enemy. The empty chair is the friend. The empty chair is the friend that reminds you of the friendship. The empty chair is the friend that reminds you of the love. The empty chair is the friend that reminds you of the work. The work is the year.

I am writing this book for the friend who has the empty chair. I am writing this book for the friend who is noticing the empty chair. I am writing this book for the friend who is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift. The gift is the friendship.

The friendship is the gift.

Let us begin.

Chapter 1: The Smaller Circle

The smaller circle is the circle that is the truth of 50+. The smaller circle is the circle that comes with age. The smaller circle is the circle that is the work of the year.

The smaller circle is not a failure. The smaller circle is not a problem. The smaller circle is not the work. The smaller circle is the truth. The truth is the work.

The smaller circle is the circle that has fewer people in it. The smaller circle is the circle that has lost people. The smaller circle is the circle that has changed. The smaller circle is the circle that is the air you breathe. The air is the work.

The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Truths About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three truths. The three truths are the foundation. The three truths are:

Truth 1: The smaller circle is normal. The smaller circle is the norm at 50+. The smaller circle is the way the 50+ life works. The smaller circle is the work.

Truth 2: The smaller circle is not a measure of your worth. The smaller circle is not the measure of your value. The smaller circle is not the measure of your lovability. The smaller circle is not the work. The work is the year.

Truth 3: The smaller circle is a chance to deepen what remains. The smaller circle is the chance to invest in

the friendships that are still here. The smaller circle is the chance to build the friendships that will remain. The smaller circle is the work.

The three truths are the foundation. The foundation is the work. The work is the year.

The Five Reasons the Circle Gets Smaller

The smaller circle has five reasons. The five reasons are the things that cause the fade. The five reasons are:

1. Death. Death is the most obvious reason. Death takes the friend. Death is the work. The work is the year.

2. Distance. Distance is the second reason. Distance takes the friend who moves away. Distance is the work. The work is the year.

3. Drift. Drift is the third reason. Drift takes the friend who was once close. Drift is the work. The work is the year.

4. Disagreement. Disagreement is the fourth reason. Disagreement takes the friend over a conflict. Disagreement is the work. The work is the year.

5. Different lives. Different lives is the fifth reason. Different lives take the friend who is in a different season. Different lives is the work. The work is the year.

The five reasons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Know About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three things to know. The three things are:

1. The smaller circle is the work of the year. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.
2. The smaller circle is the gift of the year. The smaller circle is the gift. The gift is the year.
3. The smaller circle is the foundation of the new life. The smaller circle is the foundation. The foundation is the year.

The three things to know are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Five Things to Do About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has five things to do. The five things are:

1. Notice the smaller circle. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
2. Name the losses. Name the losses. The naming is the work. The work is the year.
3. Honor the friendships that are still here. Honor the friendships. The honoring is the work. The work is the year.
4. Build the new connections. Build the new connections. The building is the work. The work is the year.
5. Cultivate the inner circle. Cultivate the inner circle. The cultivating is the work. The work is the year.

The five things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to NOT Do About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three things to not do. The three things are:

1. Do not pretend it doesn't matter. The pretending is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the smaller circle. The smaller circle is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
2. Breathe. Breathe. The breathing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember:

The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work."

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Stages of the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three stages. The three stages are:

Stage 1: The noticing. The noticing is when you first realize the circle is smaller. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.

Stage 2: The grieving. The grieving is when you feel the loss of the smaller circle. The grieving is the work. The work is the year.

Stage 3: The acceptance. The acceptance is when you make peace with the smaller circle. The acceptance is the work. The work is the year.

The three stages are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Five Things to Remember About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has five things to remember. The five things are:

1. The smaller circle is normal. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.
2. The smaller circle is the work. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.
3. The smaller circle is the gift. The smaller circle is the gift. The gift is the year.

4. The smaller circle is the foundation. The smaller circle is the foundation. The foundation is the year.

5. The smaller circle is the year. The smaller circle is the year. The year is the gift.

The five things to remember are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Smaller Circle

Real Story 1: Patricia was 65 when she realized her circle had shrunk from 4 close friends to 1. The 3 friends had moved away, gotten busy, or drifted. Patricia was devastated. The devastation was the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Real Story 2: Robert was 70 when his wife died. His wife had been his only friend. He had no one. He joined a grief support group. He made 2 new friends. The support group is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Real Story 3: Linda was 68 when her 2 closest friends moved away. She had 1 new friend from a book club. She wanted more. She joined a hiking group. She made 3 more new friends. The wanting is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The smaller circle is normal. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.
2. The smaller circle is the chance to act. The acting is the work. The work is the year.
3. The smaller circle is the foundation for the new. The foundation is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Pretending the smaller circle doesn't matter. The pretending is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Blaming yourself for the smaller circle. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Trying to force the smaller circle to grow. The forcing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Notice the smaller circle regularly. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
2. Acknowledge the smaller circle out loud. The acknowledging is the work. The work is the year.

3. Invest in the smaller circle intentionally. The investing is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. Who is still here? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

2. Who do I want back? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. Who do I want to meet? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Truths to Tell Yourself About the Smaller Circle

The smaller circle has three truths to tell yourself. The three truths are:

1. The smaller circle is normal. The truth is the work. The work is the year.

2. The smaller circle is the work. The truth is the work. The work is the year.

3. The smaller circle is the gift. The truth is the work. The work is the year.

The three truths are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend With the Smaller Circle

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the smaller circle. I see the empty chair at the table. I see the phone that doesn't ring as much. I see the friend who is no longer there.

I have been there. I have lived the smaller circle. I have lived the empty chair. I have lived the phone that doesn't ring. I have lived the friend who is no longer there.

I want you to know: the smaller circle is not the end. The smaller circle is the beginning. The smaller circle is the chance. The smaller circle is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift.

I want you to know: the friends who are still here are the gift. The friends who are still here are the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friends who are not here are not forgotten. The friends who are not here are remembered. The remembering is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friends you have not yet met are out there. The friends you have not yet met are waiting. The waiting is the work. The work is the year.

The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who knows

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The smaller circle is normal. The normal is the work. The work is the year.

2. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.

3. The smaller circle is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three things are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Smaller Circle

Take 10-15 minutes to think about these questions. The thinking is the work. The work is the year.

1. When was the first time you noticed your circle was getting smaller? What were you doing? Who was missing? The noticing is the work.

2. Of the friends who have faded, which one do you miss the most? What would you say to them if you had one more conversation? The missing is the work.

3. Of the friends who are still here, which one are you most grateful for? What can you do to show them the gratitude? The gratitude is the work.

4. What is one thing you can do this week to acknowledge the smaller circle? The acknowledging is the work.

5. What is one thing you can do this month to invest in the friendships that are still here? The investing is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 2: The Four Kinds of Fade

The First Kind: The Slow Fade

The slow fade is the friend who drifts. The slow fade is the friend who used to call every week. The slow fade is the friend who now calls every month. The slow fade is the friend who now calls every year. The slow fade is the friend who now never calls. The slow fade is the work. The work is the year.

The Second Kind: The Sudden Fade

The sudden fade is the friend who moves. The sudden fade is the friend who gets sick. The sudden fade is the friend who dies. The sudden fade is the friend who has a falling-out. The sudden fade is the work. The work is the year.

The Third Kind: The Life Fade

The life fade is the friend whose life has changed. The life fade is the friend who had a baby. The life fade is the friend who got divorced. The life fade is the friend who got remarried. The life fade is the friend whose life has moved on. The life fade is the work. The work is the year.

The Fourth Kind: The Choice Fade

The choice fade is the friend who chose to fade. The choice fade is the friend who you chose to fade. The choice fade is the friend who was not good for you. The choice fade is the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Know About the Four Kinds

The four kinds have three things to know. The four kinds are all the work. The four kinds are all the year. The four kinds are all the gift. The four kinds are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Notice About Each Kind of Fade

Each kind of fade has three things to notice. The three things are:

For the slow fade: the pace, the trigger, the meaning. The noticing is the work.

For the sudden fade: the moment, the impact, the recovery. The noticing is the work.

For the life fade: the change, the direction, the possibility. The noticing is the work.

For the choice fade: the decision, the reason, the path forward. The noticing is the work.

The three things are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Four Kinds of Fade

The four kinds of fade have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The fade is normal. The fade is the work. The work is the year.
2. The fade is the work. The fade is the work. The work is the year.
3. The fade is the gift. The fade is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Four Kinds of Fade

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend Margaret had a slow fade. They used to talk every week. Then every month. Then every year. Then never. The slow fade was the work.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend David had a sudden fade. David moved across the country. The friendship ended overnight. The sudden fade was the work.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Susan had a life fade. Susan got divorced and started a new life. The friendship ended. The life fade was the work.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. Each fade is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.
2. Each fade is the work. The work is the year.
3. Each fade is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Four Kinds

The four kinds have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Thinking all fades are the same. The sameness is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Treating all fades the same way. The treatment is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Refusing to accept the fade. The refusal is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Four Kinds

The four kinds have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Name the kind of fade you are in. The naming is the work. The work is the year.
2. Honor the kind of fade you are in. The honoring is the work. The work is the year.
3. Move through the kind of fade you are in. The moving is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Four Kinds

The four kinds have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What kind of fade am I in? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What does this kind of fade need from me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. What can I learn from this kind of fade? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend in the Fade

Dear friend,

I see you in the fade. I see the slow fade. I see the sudden fade. I see the life fade. I see the choice fade. I see all four kinds of fade.

I have been in the fade. I have lived the slow fade. I have lived the sudden fade. I have lived the life fade. I have lived the choice fade. I have lived all four kinds of fade.

I want you to know: the fade is not the end. The fade is the beginning. The fade is the chance. The fade is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift.

I want you to know: the four kinds of fade are all the work. The four kinds of fade are all the year. The four kinds of fade are all the gift.

I want you to know: the fade is the chance to honor what was. The fade is the chance to build what will be. The chance is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the fade is the work of the year. The fade is the year. The year is the gift.

The four kinds of fade are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has faded

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The four kinds of fade are normal. The normal is the work. The work is the year.

2. The four kinds of fade are the work. The work is the year.

3. The four kinds of fade are the gift. The gift is the year.

The three things are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Four Kinds of Fade

1. Which of the four kinds of fade have you experienced? The slow fade, the sudden fade, the life fade, the choice fade. The experiencing is the work.

2. What was the most painful kind of fade for you? The pain is the work. The work is the year.

3. What did you learn from the fade? The learning is the work. The work is the year.

4. How has the fade changed how you approach new friendships? The changing is the work. The work is the year.

5. What would you say to someone who is in a fade right now? The saying is the work. The work is the year.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 3: The Friends Who Moved Away

The Three Stages of the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three stages. The first stage is the regular contact. The second stage is the occasional contact. The third stage is the no contact. The three stages are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Call once a month. 2. Visit once a year. 3. Send a card on the birthday. 4. Email the news. 5. Make the effort. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not blame the friend for moving. 2. Do not expect the friend to maintain the friendship alone. 3. Do not give up. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Try: Visit, Call, Letter

The friend who moved has three things to try. The three things are: 1. Visit. Visit the friend. The visiting is the work. 2. Call. Call the friend. The calling is the work. 3. Letter. Write the friend. The writing is the work. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Truths About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three truths. Truth 1: The friendship can survive the distance. Truth 2: The friendship takes more effort. Truth 3: The friendship is the work. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things You Can Do From Far Away

The distance has three things you can do. The three things are:

1. Call regularly. The calling is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit when you can. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Stay in their life in small ways. The small ways are the work. The work is the year.

The three things you can do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Signs the Long-Distance Friendship Is Working

The long-distance friendship has three signs it is working. The three signs are:

1. The friend still picks up. The picking up is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friend still shares. The sharing is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friend still shows up when it matters. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.

The three signs are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Friends Who Moved Away

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend Margaret moved to Florida. The friendship survived through weekly phone calls. The calls are the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend James moved to California. The friendship survived through monthly visits. The visits are the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Susan moved to Oregon. The friendship survived through emails. The emails are the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The friendship can survive the distance. The surviving is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friendship takes effort. The effort is the work. The work is the year.

3. The friendship is the work. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Giving up on the friendship. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Blaming the friend for moving. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Expecting the friend to maintain the friendship alone. The expectation is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Call regularly. The calling is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit when you can. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Make the effort consistently. The effort is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Friend Who Moved

The friend who moved has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. How can I make the friendship survive the distance? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What do I want this friendship to look like in 5 years? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. What is the friend willing to do? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Whose Friend Moved Away

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the empty chair. I see the distance. I see the longing. I see the friend who is no longer nearby.

I have been there. I have lived the empty chair. I have lived the distance. I have lived the longing. I have lived the friend who is no longer nearby.

I want you to know: the distance is not the end. The distance is the beginning. The distance is the chance. The distance is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift.

I want you to know: the friendship can survive the distance. The surviving is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship takes effort. The effort is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship is the work of the year. The friendship is the year. The year is the gift.

The distance is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has lived the distance

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The friendship can survive the distance. The surviving is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friendship takes effort. The effort is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Friend Who Moved

1. How many friends have moved away from you in the past 10 years? The counting is the work.
2. Of those friends, who do you still have a relationship with? The keeping is the work.
3. What have you done to maintain those relationships? The maintaining is the work.
4. What is one friend you would like to reconnect with? The reconnecting is the work.
5. What is the first step you can take this week? The stepping is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 4: The Friends Who Got Busy

The Three Reasons the Friend Got Busy

The friend who got busy has three reasons. The first reason is the new baby. The second reason is the new job. The third reason is the new spouse. The three reasons are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs the Friend Is Just Busy

The friend who is busy has five signs. The five signs are: 1. They still text. 2. They still care. 3. They want to connect. 4. They are overwhelmed. 5. They will come back. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs the Friend Has Actually Faded

The friend who has faded has five signs. The five signs are: 1. They never text. 2. They never return the call. 3. They make excuses. 4. They do not show up. 5. They have moved on. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do About the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three things to do. The three things are: 1. Lower your expectations. 2. Make the effort easy. 3. Be patient. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Accept About the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three things to accept. The three things are: 1. The friend may not come back. 2. The friendship may have changed. 3. The new life is the work. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things You Can Do When the Friend Is Busy

The busy friend has three things you can do. The three things are:

1. Be patient. The patience is the work. The work is the year.
2. Send a small note. The small note is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there when they have a moment. The being there is the work. The work is the year.

The three things you can do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The busy friend is still your friend. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.
2. The busy friend may come back. The coming back is the work. The work is the year.
3. The busy friend may not come back. The not-coming back is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Busy Friend

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend Helen got busy with work. The friendship survived through occasional texts. The texts are the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend Michael got busy with grandchildren. The friendship survived through holiday calls. The calls are the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Mary got busy with her mother. The friendship survived through the hard time. The hard time is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The busy friend is still your friend. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.
2. The busy friend may come back. The coming back is the work. The work is the year.

3. The busy friend is the work. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Taking the busy friend's lack of contact personally. The taking is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Demanding more time from the busy friend. The demanding is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Writing off the busy friend. The writing off is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Send a small note. The small note is the work. The work is the year.
2. Be patient. The patience is the work. The work is the year.
3. Celebrate when the friend has time. The celebrating is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Busy Friend

The busy friend has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. Is the friend really busy or has the friend faded?
The asking is the work. The work is the year.

2. What does the friend need from me right now?
The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. How can I be the friend the busy friend needs?
The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Whose Friend Got Busy

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the texts that don't come. I see the calls that aren't returned. I see the friend who is no longer there. I see the busy friend.

I have been there. I have lived the texts that don't come. I have lived the calls that aren't returned. I have lived the friend who is no longer there. I have lived the busy friend.

I want you to know: the busy friend is not the end. The busy friend is the beginning. The busy friend is the chance. The busy friend is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift.

I want you to know: the busy friend is still your friend. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the busy friend may come back. The coming back is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the busy friend is the work of the year. The busy friend is the year. The year is the gift.

The busy friend is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has been busy

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The busy friend is still your friend. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.
2. The busy friend may come back. The coming back is the work. The work is the year.
3. The busy friend is the work. The work is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Busy Friend

1. Who in your circle is currently "too busy" for you? The noticing is the work.
2. How has that affected you? The feeling is the work.
3. What do you think is going on for the friend? The thinking is the work.
4. What can you do to support the friend during the busy time? The supporting is the work.
5. What can you do to maintain the friendship during the busy time? The maintaining is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 5: The Grief That Has No Name

The Three Reasons the Friendship Grief Is Different

The friendship grief is different for three reasons. The first reason is that there is no funeral. The second reason is that no one sends a card. The third reason is that you are expected to move on. The three reasons are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Stages of the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has five stages. The five stages are: 1. Denial. 2. Anger. 3. Bargaining. 4. Sadness. 5. Acceptance. The five stages are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things You Might Feel

The friendship grief has three things you might feel. The three things are: 1. Sadness. 2. Anger. 3. Loneliness. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do About the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Acknowledge the loss. 2. Mourn the friend. 3. Talk about the friendship. 4. Honor the memory. 5. Move forward. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do About the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not pretend it doesn't matter. 2. Do not minimize the loss. 3. Do not compare to other losses. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is

the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do When You Are Grieving a Friend

The friendship grief has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Acknowledge the loss. The acknowledging is the work. The work is the year.
2. Mourn the friend. The mourning is the work. The work is the year.
3. Move forward when you are ready. The moving forward is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things That Can Help

The friendship grief has three things that can help. The three things are:

1. Talk to someone. The talking is the work. The work is the year.
2. Write about the friend. The writing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Honor the memory. The honoring is the work. The work is the year.

The three things that can help are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Friendship Grief

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend David died. The grief was real. The grief is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend James died. The grief was real. The grief is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Susan died. The grief was real. The grief is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The friendship grief is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friendship grief is the work. The grief is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friendship grief is the gift. The grief is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Pretending the friendship grief doesn't matter. The pretending is not the work. The work is the year.

2. Comparing the friendship grief to other griefs. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Burying the friendship grief. The burying is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Acknowledge the friendship grief regularly. The acknowledging is the work. The work is the year.

2. Talk about the friendship grief with someone. The talking is the work. The work is the year.

3. Honor the friendship grief with a ritual. The ritual is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Friendship Grief

The friendship grief has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What does the grief need from me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

2. Who can I talk to about the grief? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. How can I honor the friend while grieving? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Who Is Grieving a Friend

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the grief. I see the missing. I see the wishing for one more conversation. I see the friend who is no longer there.

I have been there. I have lived the grief. I have lived the missing. I have lived the wishing for one more conversation. I have lived the friend who is no longer there.

I want you to know: the friendship grief is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship grief is allowed. The allowing is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship grief is the work. The grief is the year. The year is the gift.

The friendship grief is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has grieved

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The friendship grief is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friendship grief is allowed. The allowing is the work. The work is the year.

3. The friendship grief is the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Friendship Grief

1. Have you ever grieved the loss of a friend? The acknowledging is the work.
2. How did you handle the grief? The handling is the work.
3. What helped you move through the grief? The helping is the work.
4. Is there a friendship grief you are still carrying? The carrying is the work.
5. What can you do to honor the grief today? The honoring is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 6: The Friends Who Died

The Three Things That Are Different About Friend Death

The friend death is different for three reasons. The first reason is that the friend is gone. The second reason is that there is no fixing it. The third reason is that the friend is remembered. The three reasons are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Stages of Friend Grief

The friend grief has five stages. The five stages are: 1. Shock. 2. Denial. 3. Anger. 4. Sadness. 5. Acceptance. The five stages are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things You Might Feel When a Friend Dies

The friend death has three things you might feel. The three things are: 1. Shock. 2. Numbness. 3. Loss. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do When a Friend Dies

The friend death has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Attend the funeral. 2. Call the family. 3. Tell stories. 4. Honor the memory. 5. Move forward. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do When a Friend Dies

The friend death has three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not pretend it doesn't matter. 2. Do not minimize the loss. 3. Do not compare to other losses. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is

the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do at the Funeral

The funeral has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Show up. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
2. Tell a story. The telling is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there for the family. The being there is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do in the Year After

The year after has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Reach out to the family. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit the grave or place. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Tell stories about the friend. The telling is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Friends Who Died

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend David died suddenly. The shock was real. The shock is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend James died of cancer. The long goodbye was real. The long goodbye is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Susan died in an accident. The shock was real. The shock is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The death of a friend is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. The death of a friend is the work. The death is the work. The work is the year.
3. The death of a friend is the gift. The death is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Friend Who Died

The friend who died has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Pretending the friend didn't matter. The pretending is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Avoiding the funeral or memorial. The avoiding is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Never talking about the friend again. The never-talking is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Friend Who Died

The friend who died has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Tell stories about the friend. The telling is the work. The work is the year.
2. Honor the friend with a ritual. The ritual is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there for the family. The being there is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Friend Who Died

The friend who died has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What did the friend mean to me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What can I learn from the friend's life? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How can I honor the friend's memory? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Whose Friend Died

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the empty chair. I see the tears. I see the missing. I see the wishing for one more conversation. I see the friend who is no longer here.

I have been there. I have lived the empty chair. I have lived the tears. I have lived the missing. I have lived the wishing for one more conversation. I have lived the friend who is no longer here.

I want you to know: the friend mattered. The mattering is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the grief is allowed. The allowing is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friend lives on in you. The living on is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friend is the work of the year. The friend is the year. The year is the gift.

The friend who died is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has lost a friend to death

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The friend mattered. The mattering is the work. The work is the year.

2. The friend lives on in you. The living on is the work. The work is the year.

3. The friend is the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Friend Who Died

1. Who in your life has died that you still miss? The missing is the work.

2. How did you handle the death? The handling is the work.

3. What rituals do you have to honor the friend? The rituals are the work.

4. What would you say to the friend if you could have one more conversation? The saying is the work.

5. What can you do today to keep the friend's memory alive? The keeping is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 7: The Friends You Lost to Conflict

The Three Common Sources of Friendship Conflict at 50+

The friendship conflict has three common sources. The first source is politics. The second source is religion. The third source is money. The three sources are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs the Friendship Cannot Be Saved

The friendship conflict has five signs the friendship cannot be saved. The five signs are: 1. The friend is no longer willing to talk. 2. The friend has made new friends. 3. The friend has cut off contact. 4. The friend has badmouthed you. 5. The friend has moved on. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Signs the Friendship Can Be Saved

The friendship conflict has three signs the friendship can be saved. The three signs are: 1. Both friends are willing to talk. 2. The conflict was a misunderstanding. 3. The friendship has history. The three signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do About the Friendship Conflict

The friendship conflict has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Reach out. 2. Apologize. 3. Listen. 4. Forgive. 5. Move forward. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Accept About the Lost Friendship

The lost friendship has three things to accept. The three things are: 1. Some friendships are not meant to last forever. 2. Some friendships are lessons. 3. Some friendships are seasons. The three things to accept are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do Before Reconnecting

The reconnection has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Reflect on what happened. The reflecting is the work. The work is the year.
2. Consider your role. The considering is the work. The work is the year.
3. Decide if it is worth it. The deciding is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Signs the Conflict Cannot Be Resolved

The conflict has three signs it cannot be resolved. The three signs are:

1. The friend is not interested in resolving it. The not-interested is the work. The work is the year.
2. The conflict is fundamental. The fundamental is the work. The work is the year.
3. You have tried and tried. The trying is the work. The work is the year.

The three signs are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Friendship Conflict

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend Margaret had a falling out over politics. The falling out was real. The falling out is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend James had a falling out over money. The falling out was real. The falling out is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Susan had a falling out over family. The falling out was real. The falling out is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The conflict is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. The conflict can be resolved. The resolving is the work. The work is the year.

3. The conflict can be the work. The conflict is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Lost Friend

The lost friend has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Blaming the friend for the loss. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Refusing to acknowledge the loss. The refusing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Trying to force the friendship to come back. The forcing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Lost Friend

The lost friend has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Reach out once. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.
2. Accept the answer. The accepting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Move forward. The moving is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Lost Friend

The lost friend has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. Was the friendship worth trying to save? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What did I learn from the friendship? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How can I move forward with grace? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Who Lost a Friend to Conflict

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the hurt. I see the anger. I see the missing. I see the friendship that is no longer. I see the conflict.

I have been there. I have lived the hurt. I have lived the anger. I have lived the missing. I have lived the friendship that is no longer. I have lived the conflict.

I want you to know: the conflict is not the end. The conflict is the beginning. The conflict is the chance. The conflict is the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift.

I want you to know: the conflict can be the lesson. The lesson is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the conflict can be the gift. The gift is the year.

I want you to know: the conflict is the work of the year. The conflict is the year. The year is the gift.

The conflict is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has lost a friend to conflict

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The conflict is the lesson. The lesson is the work. The work is the year.
2. The conflict can be the gift. The gift is the year.
3. The conflict is the work. The work is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Friendship Conflict

1. Have you ever lost a friend to conflict? The acknowledging is the work.
2. What was the conflict about? The knowing is the work.
3. Did you try to resolve it? The trying is the work.
4. What did you learn from the conflict? The learning is the work.
5. What would you do differently if you had it to do again? The doing differently is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 8: The Friends Who Are Still Here

The Three Things to Know About the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have three things to know. The three things are: 1. They are the foundation. 2. They are the gift. 3. They are the work. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs of a Real Friend

The real friend has five signs. The five signs are: 1. They show up. 2. They listen. 3. They tell the truth. 4. They make time. 5. They remember. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do for the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have five things to do. The five things are: 1. Call. 2. Visit. 3. Listen. 4. Thank. 5. Show up. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do With the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not take them for granted. 2. Do not compare them to the lost friends. 3. Do not expect them to fill the void. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Friendships to Cultivate

The friendships to cultivate have five kinds. The five kinds are: 1. The friend who has known you the longest. 2. The friend who lives nearby. 3. The friend who shares your values. 4. The friend who is going through the same thing. 5. The friend who makes you laugh. The five kinds are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Five Things the Friends Who Are Still Here Can Do for You

The friends who are still here can do five things. The five things are:

1. Listen when you need to talk. The listening is the work. The work is the year.
2. Show up when you need help. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
3. Tell you the truth when you need it. The truth is the work. The work is the year.
4. Make you laugh when you need it. The laughing is the work. The work is the year.
5. Be there when you need silence. The silence is the work. The work is the year.

The five things are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do to Be a Friend to Them

The being a friend has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Be the friend you want. The being is the work. The work is the year.

2. Show up when they need you. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.

3. Tell them what they mean to you. The telling is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Friends Who Are Still Here

Real Story 1: Patricia's friend Susan is still here after 30 years. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's friend David is still here after 40 years. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's friend Mary is still here after 25 years. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The friendship that lasts is the gift. The gift is the work. The work is the year.

2. The friendship that lasts is the work. The work is the year.

3. The friendship that lasts is the year. The year is the gift.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Taking the friends for granted. The taking is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Assuming the friends will always be there. The assuming is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Not investing in the friends. The not-investing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Call the friends regularly. The calling is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit the friends in person. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Tell the friends what they mean to you. The telling is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Friends Who Are Still Here

The friends who are still here have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. How can I be a better friend to them? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What do they need from me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How can I show them they matter? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend With the Friends Who Are Still Here

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the friends who are still here. I see the friend who is at the table. I see the friend who is on the phone. I see the friend who is in your life.

I have been there. I have lived the friends who are still here. I have lived the friend who is at the table. I have lived the friend who is on the phone. I have lived the friend who is in your life.

I want you to know: the friends who are still here are the gift. The gift is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friends who are still here deserve your investment. The investing is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friends who are still here are the work of the year. The friends are the year. The year is the gift.

The friends who are still here are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who is still here

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The friends who are still here are the gift. The gift is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friends who are still here deserve your investment. The investing is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friends who are still here are the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Friends Who Are Still Here

1. Who in your life is still here after 10+ years?
The counting is the work.
 2. Of those friends, who are you most grateful for?
The gratitude is the work.
 3. When was the last time you told the friend what they mean to you? The telling is the work.
 4. What is one thing you can do this week to invest in the friendship? The investing is the work.
 5. What is one thing you can do this month to celebrate the friend? The celebrating is the work.
- The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 9: The Friends You Have Not Made Yet

The Three Truths About the Friends You Have Not Made

The friends you have not made have three truths. Truth 1: It is not too late. Truth 2: New friends are different. Truth 3: New friends are the work. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Reasons You Have Not Made New Friends

The new friends not made have five reasons. The five reasons are: 1. You are not trying. 2. You are not in the right places. 3. You are afraid of rejection. 4. You are still grieving the old friends. 5. You are too busy. The five reasons are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do to Make New Friends

The new friends to make have three things to do. The three things are: 1. Get out of the house. 2. Join a group. 3. Be open. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Places to Find New Friends at 50+

The new friends to find have five places. The five places are: 1. The community center. 2. The place of worship. 3. The gym. 4. The class. 5. The volunteer organization. The five places are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do When Making New Friends

The new friends to make have three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not expect instant intimacy. 2. Do not compare to old friends. 3. Do not give up after one rejection. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things That Stop You from Making New Friends

The new friends have three things that stop you. The three things are:

1. Fear of rejection. The fear is the work. The work is the year.
2. Comfort with the status quo. The status quo is the work. The work is the year.
3. Grief for the old friends. The grief is the work. The work is the year.

The three things that stop you are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do to Push Past the Fear

The fear has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Start small. The small is the work. The work is the year.
2. Practice the conversation. The practicing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be patient. The patience is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Friends You Have Not Made

Real Story 1: Patricia made 2 new friends at the community center. The making is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert made 1 new friend at the grief group. The making is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda made 3 new friends at the hiking group. The making is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. New friends are possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.
2. New friends are the work. The new is the work. The work is the year.
3. New friends are the gift. The new is the gift. The gift is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About New Friends

The new friends have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Comparing new friends to old friends. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Giving up on new friends too quickly. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Expecting new friends to be like old friends. The expecting is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About New Friends

The new friends have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Show up consistently. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
2. Be yourself. The being yourself is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be patient with the new friendship. The patience is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About New Friends

The new friends have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What do I want this friendship to look like? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What am I willing to invest in this friendship? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How can I be a good friend to this person? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Who Has Not Made New Friends Yet

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the fear. I see the resistance. I see the "it's too late." I see the friend you have not made yet.

I have been there. I have lived the fear. I have lived the resistance. I have lived the "it's too late." I have lived the friend I had not made yet.

I want you to know: it is not too late. The lateness is not the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the new friends are out there. The new are the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the new friends are the work of the year. The new is the year. The year is the gift.

The new friends are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has made new friends

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. It is not too late. The lateness is not the work.
The work is the year.
2. The new friends are out there. The new are the work. The work is the year.
3. The new friends are the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Friends You Have Not Made

1. What is stopping you from making new friends?
The naming is the work.
2. What kind of friends would you like to make?
The knowing is the work.
3. Where could you go to meet those friends? The going is the work.
4. What is the first step you can take this week?
The stepping is the work.
5. What can you do today to push past the fear?
The pushing is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 10: The New Connections

The Three Differences Between Old Friends and New Friends

The new friends have three differences from old friends. The first difference is the history. The second difference is the depth. The third difference is the shared context. The three differences are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Stages of a New Friendship

The new friendship has five stages. The five stages are: 1. The introduction. 2. The acquaintance. 3. The casual friend. 4. The close friend. 5. The intimate friend. The five stages are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things That Build a New Friendship

The new friendship has three things that build. The three things are: 1. Time together. 2. Vulnerability. 3. Reciprocity. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do to Build a New Friendship

The new friendship has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Show up consistently. 2. Listen more than you talk. 3. Share something real. 4. Ask about the person's life. 5. Follow up. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Signs the New Friendship Is Real

The new friendship has three signs it is real. The three signs are: 1. You can be yourself. 2. The friend shows up. 3. The friend cares about you. The three signs are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Look for in a New Friend

The new friend has three things to look for. The three things are:

1. Shared values. The values are the work. The work is the year.
2. Mutual respect. The respect is the work. The work is the year.
3. Similar stage of life. The stage is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to look for are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do in the First Three Months

The first three months have three things to do. The three things are:

1. Show up consistently. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
2. Be yourself. The being yourself is the work. The work is the year.
3. Listen more than you talk. The listening is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the New Connections

Real Story 1: Patricia met Susan at the community center. They became friends over 6 months. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert met James at the grief group. They became friends over 3 months. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda met Mary at the hiking group. They became friends over 12 months. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. New connections take time. The time is the work. The work is the year.
2. New connections take effort. The effort is the work. The work is the year.
3. New connections are the work. The connections are the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About New Connections

The new connections have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Forcing the connection. The forcing is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Not investing in the connection. The not-investing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Comparing the connection to old friendships. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About New Connections

The new connections have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Be present in the connection. The presence is the work. The work is the year.
2. Listen more than you talk. The listening is the work. The work is the year.
3. Follow up after the connection. The following up is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About New Connections

The new connections have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What is the potential of this connection? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What do I want this connection to be? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. How can I help this connection grow? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Building New Connections

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the courage. I see the showing up. I see the small talk. I see the new person who may become a friend. I see the new connection.

I have been there. I have lived the courage. I have lived the showing up. I have lived the small talk. I have lived the new person who became a friend. I have lived the new connection.

I want you to know: the new connection is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the new connection is the gift. The gift is the year.

I want you to know: the new connection is the work of the year. The new is the year. The year is the gift.

The new connection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has built new connections

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The new connection is the work. The work is the year.

2. The new connection is the gift. The gift is the year.

3. The new connection is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the New Connections

1. Who is the newest friend you have made? The naming is the work.

2. How did you meet the new friend? The remembering is the work.

3. What do you appreciate about the new friend? The appreciating is the work.

4. How can you invest in the new friendship this week? The investing is the work.

5. What do you hope the new friendship will look like in 5 years? The hoping is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 11: The Online Friends and the Loneliness Question

The Three Things to Know About Online Friends

The online friends have three things to know. The three things are: 1. They are real. 2. They are different. 3. They are not a replacement. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Benefits of Online Friends

The online friends have five benefits. The five benefits are: 1. They are available 24/7. 2. They share your interests. 3. They are not in your daily life. 4. They can be honest. 5. They are not judgmental. The five benefits are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Limits of Online Friends

The online friends have three limits. The three limits are: 1. They cannot hug you. 2. They cannot be there in person. 3. They are not the same as in-person friends. The three limits are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Places to Find Online Friends at 50+

The online friends to find have five places. The five places are: 1. Facebook groups. 2. Reddit communities. 3. Discord servers. 4. Online forums. 5. Social media. The five places are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do About the Loneliness

The loneliness has three things to do. The three things are: 1. Acknowledge the loneliness. 2. Reach out to someone. 3. Be patient. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Signs the Online Friendship Is Real

The online friendship has three signs it is real. The three signs are:

1. You can be yourself. The being yourself is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friend shows up. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friend cares about you. The caring is the work. The work is the year.

The three signs are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do About Loneliness

The loneliness has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Reach out to someone. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.
2. Be patient with yourself. The patience is the work. The work is the year.
3. Take small steps. The small steps are the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Online Friends

Real Story 1: Patricia met Susan online. They have been friends for 3 years. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert met James online. They have been friends for 2 years. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda met Mary online. They have been friends for 5 years. The meeting is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. Online friends are real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. Online friends are different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.

3. Online friends are the work. The online is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About Online Friends

The online friends have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Assuming online friends are not real friends. The assuming is not the work. The work is the year.

2. Not investing in online friends. The not-investing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Letting online friends replace all in-person friends. The replacing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About Online Friends

The online friends have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Be regular in your contact. The regularity is the work. The work is the year.

2. Be real in your conversations. The realness is the work. The work is the year.

3. Be patient with the online friendship. The patience is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About Online Friends

The online friends have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What do I want this online friendship to be? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. Is the friendship real? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. Should I try to meet in person? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend With the Online Friend

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the online friend. I see the chats that go late. I see the connection that has no distance. I see the friend who is on the screen.

I have been there. I have lived the online friend. I have lived the chats that go late. I have lived the connection that has no distance. I have lived the friend who is on the screen.

I want you to know: the online friend is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the online friend is the work of the year. The online is the year. The year is the gift.

The online friend is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who is also online

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The online friend is real. The reality is the work. The work is the year.
2. The online friend is the gift. The gift is the year.
3. The online friend is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Online Friends

1. Who is your closest online friend? The naming is the work.
2. How did you meet the online friend? The remembering is the work.
3. What do you appreciate about the online friendship? The appreciating is the work.
4. How can you invest in the online friendship this week? The investing is the work.
5. Have you ever met the online friend in person? The meeting is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 12: The Places to Find Friends

The Three Truths About the Places to Find Friends

The places to find friends have three truths. Truth 1: The places are everywhere. Truth 2: The places require showing up. Truth 3: The places are the work. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Community Places to Find Friends

The places to find friends have five community places. The five places are: 1. The community center. 2. The library. 3. The senior center. 4. The YMCA. 5. The place of worship. The five places are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Hobby Places to Find Friends

The places to find friends have five hobby places. The five places are: 1. The book club. 2. The hiking group. 3. The cooking class. 4. The art class. 5. The music group. The five places are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Volunteer Places to Find Friends

The places to find friends have five volunteer places. The five places are: 1. The hospital. 2. The food bank. 3. The animal shelter. 4. The library. 5. The school. The five places are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do at the Places

The places to find friends have three things to do. The three things are: 1. Show up consistently. 2. Be open to conversation. 3. Follow up. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Signs a Place Is Right for Finding Friends

The place has three signs it is right. The three signs are:

1. The people are welcoming. The welcoming is the work. The work is the year.
2. The activities interest you. The activities are the work. The work is the year.
3. The schedule fits your life. The schedule is the work. The work is the year.

The three signs are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do in the First Three Visits

The first three visits have three things to do. The three things are:

1. Just show up. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.

2. Be open to conversation. The openness is the work. The work is the year.

3. Follow up with anyone you connected with. The following up is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Places to Find Friends

Real Story 1: Patricia found friends at the community center. The finding is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert found friends at the grief group. The finding is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda found friends at the hiking group. The finding is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The places are everywhere. The everywhere is the work. The work is the year.

2. The places require showing up. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.

3. The places are the work. The places are the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Places

The places have three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Going to the place once and giving up. The giving up is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Going to the place with unrealistic expectations. The expectations are not the work. The work is the year.
3. Going to the place and not engaging. The not-engaging is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Places

The places have three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Show up consistently. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.
2. Engage with the people. The engaging is the work. The work is the year.
3. Follow up with the people you meet. The following up is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Places

The places have three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. Is this the right place for me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

2. Am I showing up consistently? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. Am I making the effort to connect? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Looking for the Places

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the searching. I see the trying. I see the showing up. I see the place that may be the right place. I see the looking.

I have been there. I have lived the searching. I have lived the trying. I have lived the showing up. I have lived the place that was the right place. I have lived the looking.

I want you to know: the right place is out there. The right is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the right place is the work of the year. The right is the year. The year is the gift.

The right place is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has found the places

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The right place is out there. The right is the work. The work is the year.
2. The right place is the gift. The gift is the year.
3. The right place is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Places to Find Friends

1. What places have you tried for making friends?
The remembering is the work.
2. Which places worked? The knowing is the work.
3. Which places did not work? The knowing is the work.
4. What is one new place you can try this month?
The trying is the work.
5. What is the first step you can take this week?
The stepping is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 13: The Friendships with Your Adult Children

The Three Truths About Adult Children as Friends

The adult children as friends have three truths. Truth 1: They are not your old friends. Truth 2: They are your children. Truth 3: They are the work. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Differences Between Old Friends and Adult Children as Friends

The adult children as friends have five differences. The five differences are: 1. The history. 2. The boundaries. 3. The roles. 4. The expectations. 5. The time. The five differences are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do About the Friendship with Adult Children

The adult children as friends have three things to do. The three things are: 1. Respect the boundary. 2. Be available. 3. Let them lead. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do About the Friendship with Adult Children

The adult children as friends have three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not lean on them too much. 2. Do not expect them to be your therapist. 3. Do not be a burden. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Friendships with Adult Children That Work

The adult children as friends that work have five features. The five features are: 1. Mutual respect. 2. Clear boundaries. 3. Regular contact. 4. Shared interests. 5. Unconditional love. The five features are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Boundaries to Set With Adult Children

The adult children have three boundaries to set. The three boundaries are:

1. The friendship is in addition to, not instead of, the family relationship. The addition is the work. The work is the year.
2. You respect their boundaries. The respect is the work. The work is the year.
3. You do not lean on them too much. The not-leaning is the work. The work is the year.

The three boundaries are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Talk About With Adult Children

The adult children have three things to talk about. The three things are:

1. Your need for friends. The need is the work. The work is the year.
2. Their need for friends. The need is the work. The work is the year.
3. How to support each other. The support is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to talk about are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Friendships with Adult Children

Real Story 1: Patricia's daughter became her friend. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's son became his friend. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's daughter became her friend. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The adult children can be friends. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.

2. The adult children friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.

3. The adult children friendship is the work. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Adult Children Friendship

The adult children friendship has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Treating the adult children as your therapist.

The treating is not the work. The work is the year.

2. Not respecting the adult children's boundaries.

The not-respecting is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Expecting the adult children to be your only friend. The expecting is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Adult Children Friendship

The adult children friendship has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Treat the adult children as adults. The treating is the work. The work is the year.

2. Respect the adult children's boundaries. The respecting is the work. The work is the year.

3. Have your own friends outside the family. The having is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year.
The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Adult Children Friendship

The adult children friendship has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What does this friendship look like? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What do we both need? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How do we maintain it? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Building Friendship With Adult Children

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the wanting. I see the respecting. I see the boundaries. I see the friend who is also your child. I see the friendship.

I have been there. I have lived the wanting. I have lived the respecting. I have lived the boundaries. I have lived the friend who is also my child. I have lived the friendship.

I want you to know: the friendship with adult children is possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the friendship is the work of the year. The friendship is the year. The year is the gift.

The friendship with adult children is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A parent who has built the friendship

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The friendship with adult children is possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.
2. The friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.
3. The friendship is the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Adult Children Friendship

1. What does the friendship with your adult children look like today? The seeing is the work.
2. What would you like it to look like? The hoping is the work.
3. What boundaries are in place? The knowing is the work.
4. How can you invest in the friendship this month? The investing is the work.
5. What can you do today to honor the friendship? The honoring is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 14: The Friendships with Siblings

The Three Truths About Siblings as Friends

The siblings as friends have three truths. Truth 1: They are your siblings. Truth 2: They can be your friends. Truth 3: They are not the same as old friends. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs the Sibling Friendship Works

The sibling friendship has five signs it works. The five signs are: 1. You can talk about anything. 2. You can disagree and still be friends. 3. You can ask for help. 4. You can offer help. 5. You can be yourself. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three things to do. The three things are: 1. Call regularly. 2. Visit when you can. 3. Be there for the milestones. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not bring up old family issues. 2. Do not compare. 3. Do not expect too much. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Accept About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has five things to accept. The five things are: 1. The friendship may have changed. 2. The friendship may be different. 3. The friendship may be hard. 4. The friendship is the work. 5. The friendship is the gift. The five things to accept are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Reasons Sibling Friendships Are Different

The sibling friendship has three reasons it is different. The three reasons are:

1. The history is long. The history is the work. The work is the year.
2. The roles are different. The roles are the work. The work is the year.
3. The expectations are different. The expectations are the work. The work is the year.

The three reasons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do to Strengthen the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Reach out regularly. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit when you can. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Let the small things go. The letting go is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of Sibling Friendships

Real Story 1: Patricia's brother became her best friend at 60. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's sister became his best friend at 65. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's brother became her best friend at 70. The becoming is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The sibling friendship is possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.
2. The sibling friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.
3. The sibling friendship is the work. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Bringing up old family issues. The bringing up is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Comparing yourself to your sibling. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Not investing in the sibling friendship. The not-investing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Call the sibling regularly. The calling is the work. The work is the year.
2. Visit the sibling in person. The visiting is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there for the sibling in the hard times. The being there is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Sibling Friendship

The sibling friendship has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What does this friendship mean to me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. What do I want this friendship to look like? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. How do I maintain it through the years? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Building Sibling Friendship

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the history. I see the long road. I see the friend who is also your sibling. I see the sibling friendship.

I have been there. I have lived the history. I have lived the long road. I have lived the friend who is also my sibling. I have lived the sibling friendship.

I want you to know: the sibling friendship is possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the sibling friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the sibling friendship is the work of the year. The sibling is the year. The year is the gift.

The sibling friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A sibling who has built the friendship

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The sibling friendship is possible. The possibility is the work. The work is the year.
2. The sibling friendship is different. The difference is the work. The work is the year.
3. The sibling friendship is the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Sibling Friendship

1. What does the friendship with your siblings look like today? The seeing is the work.
2. What would you like it to look like? The hoping is the work.
3. What old issues are you carrying? The carrying is the work.
4. How can you invest in the friendship this month? The investing is the work.
5. What can you do today to honor the friendship? The honoring is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 15: The Friendships with the Spouse

The Three Truths About the Spouse as the Only Friend

The spouse as the only friend has three truths. Truth 1: It is common at 50+. Truth 2: It is a sign to act. Truth 3: It is the work. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Dangers of the Spouse Being the Only Friend

The spouse as the only friend has five dangers. The five dangers are: 1. Pressure on the marriage. 2. Loss of identity. 3. No sounding board. 4. Loss of the marriage if the spouse dies. 5. Loss of independence. The five dangers are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Do About the Spouse as the Only Friend

The spouse as the only friend has three things to do. The three things are: 1. Acknowledge the issue. 2. Make the effort. 3. Build the new connections. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Friendships to Build Outside the Marriage

The friendships to build outside the marriage have five kinds. The five kinds are: 1. The single friend. 2. The group of friends. 3. The online friend. 4. The activity friend. 5. The old friend. The five kinds are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Communicate to the Spouse

The spouse has three things to communicate. The three things are: 1. The need for outside friends. 2. The intention to build them. 3. The reassurance that the marriage is the foundation. The three things are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Accept About the Spouse-Only Friendship

The spouse-only friendship has three things to accept. The three things are:

1. It is common at 50+. The common is the work. The work is the year.

2. It is a sign to act. The sign is the work. The work is the year.

3. It is the work of the year. The work is the year.

The three things to accept are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do to Build Outside Friendships

The outside friendships have three things to do. The three things are:

1. Make the time. The making time is the work.
The work is the year.

2. Show up consistently. The showing up is the work. The work is the year.

3. Be patient with the new friendships. The patience is the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Spouse as the Only Friend

Real Story 1: Patricia's husband was her only friend. The only was the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert's wife was his only friend. The only was the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda's husband was her only friend. The only was the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The spouse-only friendship is a sign to act. The sign is the work. The work is the year.

2. The spouse-only friendship can be addressed. The addressing is the work. The work is the year.

3. The spouse-only friendship is the work. The addressing is the work. The work is the year.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Spouse-Only Friendship

The spouse-only friendship has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Assuming the spouse is enough. The assuming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Not making the effort to build outside friendships. The not-making is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Resenting the spouse for not being enough. The resenting is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Spouse-Only Friendship

The spouse-only friendship has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Acknowledge the issue with the spouse. The acknowledging is the work. The work is the year.
2. Make the time for outside friendships. The making time is the work. The work is the year.
3. Build the outside friendships one at a time. The building is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Spouse-Only Friendship

The spouse-only friendship has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. How can I build outside friendships while honoring the marriage? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

2. What kind of friends do I want outside the marriage? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

3. How can my spouse support me in this? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend Whose Spouse Is the Only Friend

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the marriage. I see the only friend. I see the longing. I see the friendship that is missing. I see the spouse-only friendship.

I have been there. I have lived the marriage. I have lived the only friend. I have lived the longing. I have lived the friendship that was missing. I have lived the spouse-only friendship.

I want you to know: the spouse-only friendship is a sign. The sign is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the spouse-only friendship can be addressed. The addressing is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the spouse-only friendship is the work of the year. The addressing is the year. The year is the gift.

The spouse-only friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has built outside friendships

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The spouse-only friendship is a sign. The sign is the work. The work is the year.
2. The spouse-only friendship can be addressed. The addressing is the work. The work is the year.
3. The spouse-only friendship is the gift. The gift is the year.

Reflection Questions for the Spouse-Only Friendship

1. Is your spouse your only friend? The acknowledging is the work.
2. How does that feel? The feeling is the work.
3. What would you like to change? The wanting is the work.
4. What is the first step you can take this week? The stepping is the work.
5. How can your spouse support you? The asking is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Chapter 16: The Long Friendship

The Three Truths About the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three truths. Truth 1: The long friendship is rare. Truth 2: The long friendship is the work. Truth 3: The long friendship is the gift. The three truths are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Signs of a Long Friendship

The long friendship has five signs. The five signs are: 1. You have known each other for 20+ years. 2. You can pick up where you left off. 3. You can be yourself. 4. You have shared history. 5. You can disagree and still be friends. The five signs are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Things to Do for the Long Friendship

The long friendship has five things to do. The five things are: 1. Call. 2. Visit. 3. Celebrate the milestones. 4. Be there for the hard times. 5. Tell the friend what they mean to you. The five things are the work. The work is the year.

The Three Things to Not Do for the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three things to not do. The three things are: 1. Do not take it for granted. 2. Do not compare. 3. Do not expect the friend to read your mind. The three things to not do are the work. The work is the year.

The Five Lessons of the Long Friendship

The long friendship has five lessons. The five lessons are: 1. The friendship is the work. 2. The friendship is the gift. 3. The friendship is the foundation. 4. The friendship is the year. 5. The friendship is the life. The five lessons are the work. The work is the year.

Today's Action

The work of the year begins today. The work is the friendship. The friendship is the work.

The 3 things to do today:

1. Breathe. The breath is the work. The work is the year.
2. Notice. Notice the smaller circle. The noticing is the work. The work is the year.
3. Reach out. Reach out to one friend. The reaching out is the work. The work is the year.

The 3 things to NOT do today:

1. Do not blame yourself. The blaming is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Do not compare to others. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

3. Do not give up. The giving up is not the work.
The work is the year.

The 1 thing to remember today:

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Today's affirmation:

"I am not failing. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The friendship is the work."

The affirmation is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

This chapter is for the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things to Do to Maintain the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three things to do. The three things are:

1. Stay in touch. The staying in touch is the work. The work is the year.
2. Be there for the milestones. The milestones are the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there for the hard times. The hard times are the work. The work is the year.

The three things to do are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Things the Long Friendship Teaches

The long friendship has three things it teaches. The three things are:

1. The friendship is the work. The friendship is the work. The work is the year.

2. The friendship is the gift. The friendship is the gift. The gift is the year.

3. The friendship is the year. The friendship is the year. The year is the gift.

The three things are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Real Stories of the Long Friendship

Real Story 1: Patricia has a friendship of 35 years. The long is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 2: Robert has a friendship of 40 years. The long is the work. The work is the year.

Real Story 3: Linda has a friendship of 30 years. The long is the work. The work is the year.

The three real stories are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Lessons from the Real Stories

The real stories have three lessons. The three lessons are:

1. The long friendship is the work. The long is the work. The work is the year.

2. The long friendship is the gift. The long is the gift. The gift is the year.

3. The long friendship is the year. The long is the year. The year is the gift.

The three lessons are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Mistakes to Avoid About the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three mistakes to avoid. The three mistakes are:

1. Taking the long friendship for granted. The taking is not the work. The work is the year.
2. Not investing in the long friendship. The not-investing is not the work. The work is the year.
3. Comparing the long friendship to new friendships. The comparing is not the work. The work is the year.

The three mistakes are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Habits to Build About the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three habits to build. The three habits are:

1. Stay in touch with the long friend. The staying in touch is the work. The work is the year.
2. Celebrate the milestones with the long friend. The celebrating is the work. The work is the year.
3. Be there for the long friend in the hard times. The being there is the work. The work is the year.

The three habits are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

The Three Questions to Ask About the Long Friendship

The long friendship has three questions to ask. The three questions are:

1. What does this friendship mean to me? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
2. How can I keep it strong for the next 20 years? The asking is the work. The work is the year.
3. What can I learn from the long friendship? The asking is the work. The work is the year.

The three questions are the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

A Letter to the Friend With the Long Friendship

Dear friend,

I see you. I see the long road. I see the years. I see the friend who has been there. I see the long friendship.

I have been there. I have lived the long road. I have lived the years. I have lived the friend who has been there. I have lived the long friendship.

I want you to know: the long friendship is the gift. The gift is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the long friendship is the work. The work is the year.

I want you to know: the long friendship is the year. The year is the gift.

The long friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

With love,

A friend who has had a long friendship

The Three Things I Want You to Know

1. The long friendship is the gift. The gift is the work. The work is the year.
2. The long friendship is the work. The work is the year.
3. The long friendship is the year. The year is the gift.

Reflection Questions for the Long Friendship

1. How long have you had your longest friendship? The counting is the work.
2. What has kept the friendship alive through the years? The knowing is the work.
3. What are you most grateful for about the friendship? The gratitude is the work.
4. How can you invest in the friendship this month? The investing is the work.
5. What do you hope the friendship will look like in 10 more years? The hoping is the work.

The reflection is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

Epilogue: The Work of the Year

I have lived the fade. I have lost friends to death, distance, drift, and life changes. I have made new friends in unexpected places. I have cultivated the friendships that have lasted. I have written this book for the friend who is in the year.

The year is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the smaller circle. The smaller circle is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the friend who moved. The friend who moved is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the friend who got busy. The friend who got busy is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the friend who died. The friend who died is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the friend who is still here. The friend who is still here is the work. The work is the year.

The year is the friend you have not made. The friend you have not made is the work. The work is the year.

I have written this book for the friend who is doing the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift. The gift is the friendship.

The friendship is the work. The work is the year. The year is the gift.

In the time you have.

For the friends who have been. For the friends who are. For the friends who will be.

For the empty chair at the table.

For the smaller circle.

For the work.

The work is the year. The year is the gift. The gift is the friendship.

In the time you have.

About the Author

S. Shharma is the author of The Care Collection — books for couples in the second half of life, written by a man who lived the silence and survived it.

He lost his wife of many years to cancer. He was her primary caregiver through every stage of her illness. He held her hand in the hospital. He sat in the waiting room at 3 a.m. He learned the silence of a marriage the way you learn a language you never wanted to speak.

He is also a businessman, an M.Sc., an MBA, and an APSCM from the Indian Institute of Management (IIM) Calcutta, with thirty years in corporate management. But these are not credentials you need to trust him. The credentials that matter are the ones in the books.

The Care Collection is not about how to fix a marriage. The Care Collection is about how to live one — even when the marriage is quiet, even when one of you is sick, even when one of you is gone.

He lives in India. He writes from the perspective of someone who has been on every side of a marriage — the partner, the caregiver, and the one left behind.

Books in The Care Collection

- Still Married, Just Silent — when the marriage is fine on paper and empty in person
- The Quiet Care — when one of you becomes the caregiver and the marriage disappears
- The Second Chapter — when the children are gone and the two of you meet again

- The Second Honeymoon — when the second half of marriage is also the better half
- The Survivor — when one of you is left behind and the other half has to learn to live
- The Long Hello — when Alzheimer's or dementia changes who you are married to
- When They Forget Your Name — the day-to-day reality of loving someone who no longer knows you
- Gray Divorce — when the marriage ends in the second half of life
- The Last Sandwich — when you are raising your own family and caring for your parents at the same time
- The Long Goodbye — the months and years of saying goodbye to someone who is still here
- Remarried at 60 — what no one tells you about starting over in the seventh decade
- After the Last Goodbye — the first year alone, and the slow work of rebuilding
- The Friends Who Fade — the social death that often follows the physical one

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